you, and if you're not strong, you can't help others."

"Would you do it differently knowing what you know now?" Léa asked.

"In my profession, we swear an oath to uphold the laws of the state. What do you do when the state is wrong, seizing the assets of the innocent? I chose not to uphold the laws because I didn't want to hurt those families. But in doing so, I wasn't able to help them get their property back or prevent them from being sent out of the country." He shrugged. "I don't know if it was worth it. But your situation is different. You won't hurt anyone by working in Germany. You'll be sent under a legal contract for a year, and then you'll return."

"But she'll be helping the enemy," Rose said.

"Your sister will find a way to make up for it." He smiled. "Good always cancels out the bad."

Léa's chest tightened. She couldn't believe her future hinged on a choice like this.

"Does she have to decide now?" Rose asked.

"We'll need to act quickly. Germany will not want to accept a worker who has been in an internment camp for weeks or months. Your ability to negotiate for a better position is stronger now than it will be in a few weeks . . ."

Léa knew why he'd cut off what he intended to say—when she'd be weaker.

"Decide now before the chance passes," he stressed.

"Time's up," the gendarme said.

Maître Mallon stood. "We'll come back in a few days."

"I wish I had not returned in that tunnel, but stayed with you . . ." Rose's voice cracked a little. "Then we'd have been arrested together; we'd be in the camp together. We could help one another like we always do."

"Well, I'm glad you're not in the camp with me," said Léa. If she had done anything right, it was keeping Rose out of here. "Tell Virginie I'm so very sorry about Édouard, Rose, and give Paulette a big hug from me. I love you." She blew a kiss with her hand.

"I love you, too," Rose said.

As Léa watched two of the people who meant the most to her in the world leave, she felt torn between survival and loyalty. Her head told her that the only way to endure now was to cross a line she never thought she